

Araby

James Joyce · 1914

First published: Dubliners, 1914

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Dubliners/Araby (revision 6617246), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 1 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Araby suggest about romantic idealism and disillusionment?
- What does Araby suggest about coming of age?
- What does Araby suggest about religion and desire?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards and frameworks

- **Common Core:** RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4
  Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org
- **Indiana 2023:** 7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1
  Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE

- **Dual Credit (Indiana College Core):** ICC-WC-1.1, ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.7
  Indiana College Core, Written Communication outcomes 1.1–1.7 (CHE guidance); ICC-WC-x IDs are ours
- **AP:** AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN
  AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)
- **Cambridge International:** CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5
  Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)
- **Liber et Libri program outcomes:** LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1
  Liber et Libri program outcome, not an official standard

Primary codes: RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, RL.7.2
Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	Araby	1 × 90 min (90 min)	*romantic idealism and disillusionment* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Araby

Focus: a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion

Content note (): No significant sensitive content flagged; preview as usual.
Student preview: Nothing in this story needs a special warning.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A boy on North Richmond Street, Dublin, is infatuated with his friend Mangan's sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. His uncle comes home late and drunk, and the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes. Seeing a shop girl flirt idly, he feels himself 'a creature driven and derided by vanity.'

Background: Collected in Dubliners (1914). The Araby bazaar was a real 1894 Dublin event; Joyce's stories show the 'paralysis' he saw in Irish life.

Significance: A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: Nothing in this story needs a special warning.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are impinge, converged, derided, garrulous, pitilessly. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds." In this sentence it means: to press against or strike upon. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Araby would have known. Collected in Dubliners (1914). The Araby bazaar was a real 1894 Dublin event; Joyce's stories show the 'paralysis' he saw in Irish life. Why does this story matter? A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for imagery.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "One evening I went into the back drawing-room in which the priest had died." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? I circle "impinge", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find imagery, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for imagery.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of imagery. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *One evening I went into the back drawing-room in which the priest had died. It was a dark rainy evening and there was no sound in the house. Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds. Some distant lamp or lighted window gleamed below me. I was thankful that I could see so little. All my senses seemed to desire to veil themselves and, feeling that I was about to slip from them, I pressed the palms of my hands together until they trembled, murmuring: "O love! O love!" many times.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Imagery, Point of view, Symbolism: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Araby develops the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this story connect to romantic idealism and disillusionment? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the story quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this story suggests about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Tonight, read the next story and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
impinge (verb)	to press against or strike upon	*Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
converged (verb)	came together from different directions	*These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
derided (verb)	mocked or ridiculed	*Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity; and my eyes burned with anguish and anger.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
garrulous (adjective)	talking too much, especially about unimportant things	*She was an old garrulous woman, a pawnbroker's widow, who collected used stamps for some pious purpose.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pitilessly (adverb)	without pity or mercy	*The air was pitilessly raw and already my heart misgave me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
annihilate (verb)	to destroy completely	*I wished to annihilate the tedious intervening days.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
liberated (verb)	set free	*The high cold empty gloomy rooms liberated me and I went from room to room singing.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
parcels (noun)	packages	*On Saturday evenings when my aunt went marketing I had to go to carry some of the parcels.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sixpence (noun)	a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970	*I allowed the two pennies to fall against the sixpence in my pocket.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
weakened (verb)	lessen the strength of	*Their cries reached me weakened and indistinct and, leaning my forehead against the cool glass, I looked over at the dark house where she lived.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?
2. Where does imagery appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with romantic idealism and disillusionment?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does the boy live? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: North Richmond Street, Dublin
2. Whom does the boy admire? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Mangan's sister
3. Why does he go to Araby? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: To buy her a gift
4. Why does he arrive late? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: His uncle comes home late
5. What does the boy feel at the end? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Anguish and anger at his own vanity
6. Retell the three most important events of “Araby” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A boy on North Richmond Street, Dublin, is infatuated with his friend Mangan's sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. His uncle comes home late and drunk, and the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes. Seeing a shop girl flirt idly, he feels himself 'a creature driven and derided by vanity.'
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Araby”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Araby” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.” What does “impinge” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: impinge: to press against or strike upon.
10. Reread: “These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.” What does “converged” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: converged: came together from different directions.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Araby” suggest about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.
2. Find one example of imagery in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
3. How does the point of view in this story shape what we understand about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
4. In the passage that begins “One evening I went into the back drawing-room in which the priest had died.”, why might Joyce have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Araby”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A boy on North Richmond Street, Dublin, is infatuated with his friend Mangan's sister. When she mentions the Araby bazaar, he promises to bring her a gift. His uncle comes home late and drunk, and the boy reaches the bazaar as it closes. Seeing a shop girl flirt idly, he feels himself 'a creature…
6. As the opening story, what does “Araby” set up that the rest of Araby will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever looked forward to something that disappointed you? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with romantic idealism and disillusionment? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
10. Background: Collected in Dubliners (1914). The Araby bazaar was a real 1894 Dublin event; Joyce's stories show the 'paralysis' he saw in Irish life. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “A central modernist text for epiphany; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

3. Rewrite one moment of "Araby" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
4. Write three questions of your own about "Araby": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
5. Connect this story to coming of age: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Joyce need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
6. Is the imagery in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
7. Compare how "Araby" treats a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Araby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve romantic idealism and disillusionment? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
10. What question would you most like to ask James Joyce about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Point of view**: who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Where does the boy live?
   A. London
   B. Belfast
   C. Cork
   D. North Richmond Street, Dublin
2. Whom does the boy admire?
   A. Mangan's sister
   B. His aunt
   C. A nun

D. A shop girl

3. Why does he go to Araby?
   A. To buy her a gift
   B. To work
   C. To meet friends
   D. To see his uncle
4. Why does he arrive late?
   A. The train breaks
   B. His uncle comes home late
   C. He gets lost
   D. He oversleeps
5. What does the boy feel at the end?
   A. Anguish and anger at his own vanity
   B. Relief
   C. Joy
   D. Love
6. In the line “Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.”, what does “impinge” most nearly mean?
   A. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
   B. mocked or ridiculed
   C. came together from different directions
   D. to press against or strike upon
7. In the line “These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.”, what does “converged” most nearly mean?
   A. to press against or strike upon
   B. came together from different directions
   C. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
   D. mocked or ridiculed

Answer key: 1. D (North Richmond Street, Dublin); 2. A (Mangan's sister); 3. A (To buy her a gift); 4. B (His uncle comes home late); 5. A (Anguish and anger at his own vanity); 6. D (to press against or strike upon); 7. B (came together from different directions)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this story is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Araby,” how does Joyce show a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Araby, how does Joyce develop the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Araby develops the idea of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and point of view shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Araby (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Araby suggests about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's imagery and point of view), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how James Joyce uses imagery in Araby to complicate the reader's understanding of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Araby within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Araby alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Araby and its treatment of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's imagery and point of view, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Araby as evidence for a larger claim about a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion in Araby. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Araby as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Araby.

SAT-style questions

1. *Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity; and my eyes burned with anguish and anger.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “derided” most nearly mean?

   A. a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970

   B. packages

   C. mocked or ridiculed

   D. lessen the strength of

2. *One evening I went into the back drawing-room in which the priest had died. It was a dark rainy evening and there was no sound in the house. Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds. Some distant lamp or lighted window gleamed below me. I was thankful that I could see so little. All my senses seemed to desire to veil themselves and, feeling that I was about to slip from them, I pressed the palms of my hands together until they trembled, murmuring: "O love! O love!" many times.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Araby”?

   A. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

   B. Courage in defense of home

   C. A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion

   D. The futile attempt to shut out death

SAT key: 1. C (mocked or ridiculed); 2. C (A boy's romantic quest ending in disillusion)

Whole-book test

Araby: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. Where does the boy live?
   A. London
   B. Belfast
   C. Cork
   D. North Richmond Street, Dublin
2. Whom does the boy admire?
   A. Mangan's sister
   B. His aunt
   C. A nun
   D. A shop girl
3. Why does he go to Araby?
   A. To buy her a gift
   B. To work
   C. To meet friends
   D. To see his uncle
4. Why does he arrive late?
   A. The train breaks
   B. His uncle comes home late
   C. He gets lost
   D. He oversleeps
5. What does the boy feel at the end?
   A. Anguish and anger at his own vanity
   B. Relief
   C. Joy
   D. Love
6. In the line “Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.”, what does “impinge” most nearly mean?
   A. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
   B. mocked or ridiculed
   C. came together from different directions
   D. to press against or strike upon

7. In the line “These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.”, what does “converged” most nearly mean?
   A. to press against or strike upon
   B. came together from different directions
   C. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
   D. mocked or ridiculed
8. As used in the story (“Through one of the broken panes I heard the rain impinge upon the earth, the fine incessant needles of water playing in the sodden beds.”), what does “impinge” mean?
   A. to press against or strike upon
   B. without pity or mercy
   C. packages
   D. came together from different directions
9. As used in the story (“These noises converged in a single sensation of life for me: I imagined that I bore my chalice safely through a throng of foes.”), what does “converged” mean?
   A. to destroy completely
   B. came together from different directions
   C. a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970
   D. mocked or ridiculed
10. As used in the story (“Gazing up into the darkness I saw myself as a creature driven and derided by vanity; and my eyes burned with anguish and anger.”), what does “derided” mean?
    A. set free
    B. lessen the strength of
    C. mocked or ridiculed
    D. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
11. As used in the story (“She was an old garrulous woman, a pawnbroker's widow, who collected used stamps for some pious purpose.”), what does “garrulous” mean?
    A. packages
    B. to press against or strike upon
    C. without pity or mercy
    D. talking too much, especially about unimportant things
12. As used in the story (“The air was pitilessly raw and already my heart misgave me.”), what does “pitilessly” mean?
    A. without pity or mercy
    B. a small coin of the United Kingdom worth six pennies; not minted since 1970
    C. came together from different directions
    D. to destroy completely

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how romantic idealism and disillusionment develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
2. Explain how coming of age develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.
3. Explain how religion and desire develops from the beginning of the story to the end. Use two passages.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the story's central concerns (romantic idealism and disillusionment, coming of age, religion and desire) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. D (North Richmond Street, Dublin); 2. A (Mangan's sister); 3. A (To buy her a gift); 4. B (His uncle comes home late); 5. A (Anguish and anger at his own vanity); 6. D (to press against or strike upon); 7. B (came together from different directions); 8. A (to press against or strike upon); 9. B (came together from different directions); 10. C (mocked or ridiculed); 11. D (talking too much, especially about unimportant things); 12. A (without pity or mercy)

Essay assignments

Essay: Romantic idealism and disillusionment

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Araby teaches about romantic idealism and disillusionment. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how James Joyce develops romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how James Joyce develops romantic idealism and disillusionment across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Araby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of romantic idealism and disillusionment. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how James Joyce's choices in Araby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of romantic idealism and disillusionment, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Araby's treatment of romantic idealism and disillusionment in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby. Name your

critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on romantic idealism and disillusionment in Araby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Coming of age

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Araby teaches about coming of age. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how James Joyce develops coming of age in Araby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how James Joyce develops coming of age across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Araby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of coming of age. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of coming of age in Araby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how James Joyce's choices in Araby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of coming of age, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Araby's treatment of coming of age in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on coming of age in Araby that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on coming of age in Araby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about coming of age in Araby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on coming of age in Araby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Religion and desire

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Araby teaches about religion and desire. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how James Joyce develops religion and desire in Araby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how James Joyce develops religion and desire across Araby. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Araby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of religion and desire. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of religion and desire in Araby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how James Joyce's choices in Araby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of religion and desire, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Araby's treatment of religion and desire in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on religion and desire in Araby that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on religion and desire in Araby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about religion and desire in Araby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on religion and desire in Araby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified (Online Etymology Dictionary, 2026-10-20); other words are student look-ups. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.